

General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

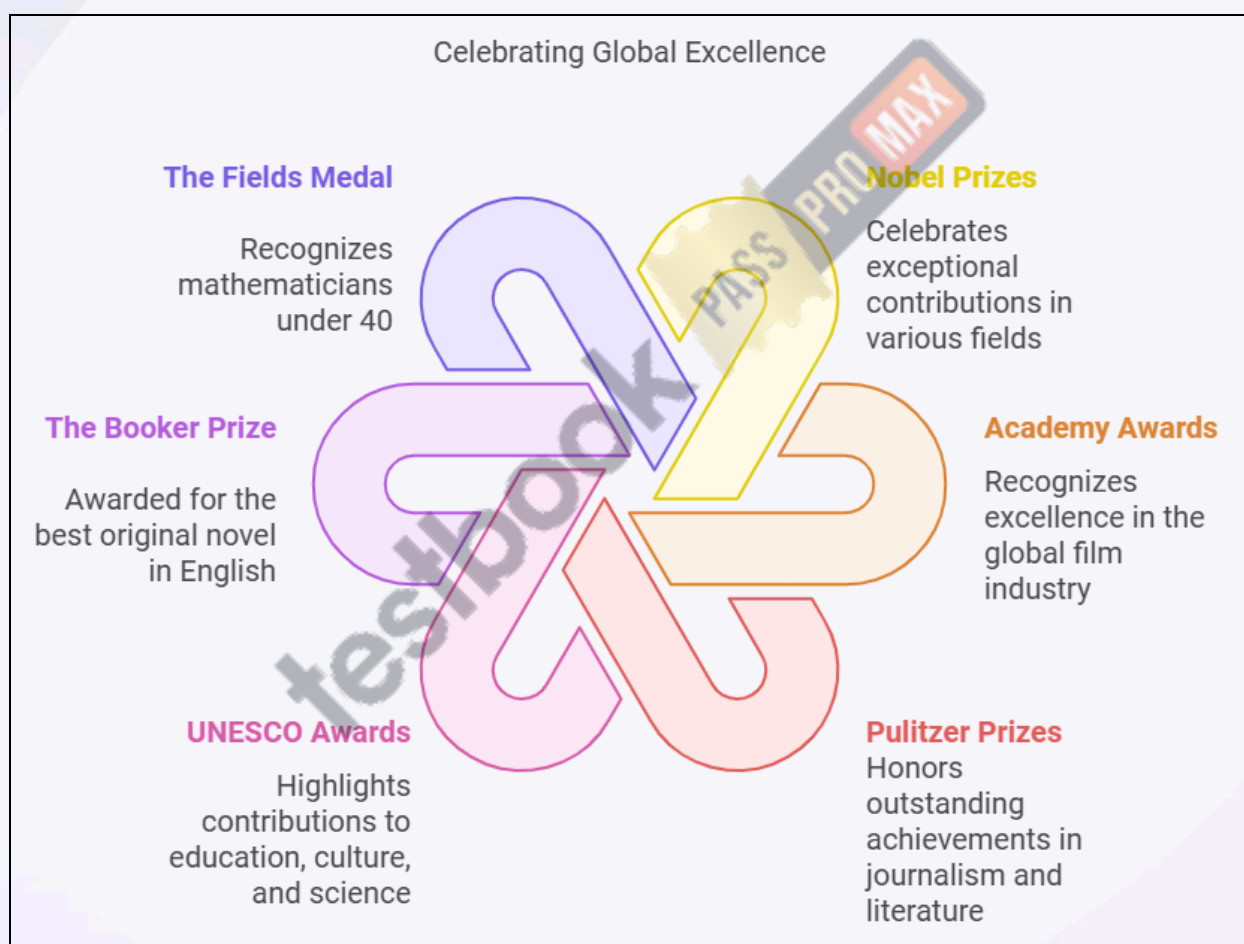
International Awards I



International Awards I

International awards are prestigious recognitions bestowed upon individuals, organisations, or countries for their exemplary contributions in **various fields, including peace, literature, science, sports, and humanitarian work**. These accolades celebrate outstanding achievements and foster inspiration across the globe.

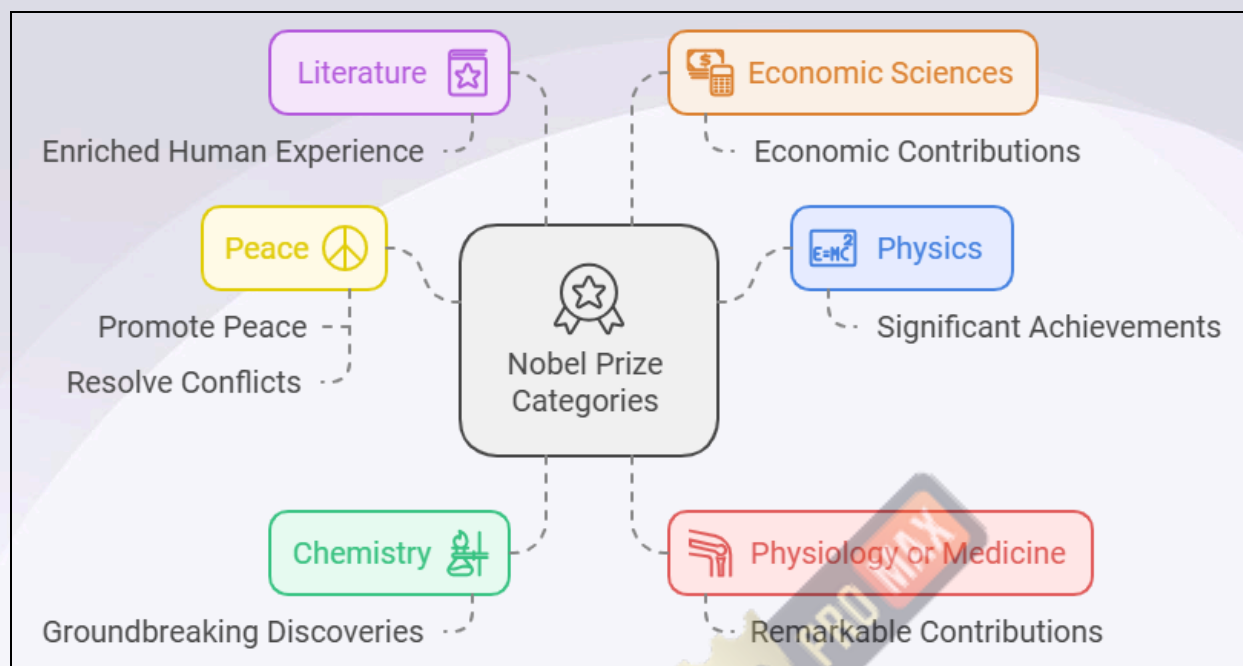
International awards often represent the highest level of recognition in their respective domains. They are awarded by renowned international institutions, committees, or governing bodies, reflecting the values of excellence, innovation, and impact on global progress.



Nobel Prizes

- The Nobel Prizes are prestigious international awards presented annually in six categories: Peace, Literature, Chemistry, Physics, Medicine (Physiology), and Economic Sciences. They were established by the will of Alfred Nobel, the inventor of dynamite, who left his fortune to fund these awards.

- They are presented annually on December 10th, the anniversary of Alfred Nobel's death.



Notable Winners:

- **Peace Prize:**
 - Malala Yousafzai (2014) – for her struggle against the suppression of children and young people and for the right of all children to education.
 - Nelson Mandela (1993) – for his work in ending apartheid in South Africa.
 - Mother Teresa (1979) – for her work in humanitarian service.
- **Literature Prize:**
 - Gabriel García Márquez (1982) – for his novels and short stories, which combine the magical and the real in a world of solitude and death.
 - Kazuo Ishiguro (2017) – for his emotionally powerful novels which uncover the hidden worlds of human lives.
- **Physics:**
 - Albert Einstein (1921) – for his discovery of the photoelectric effect.
 - Marie Curie (1903) – for her joint research on radiation phenomena.
- **Chemistry:**
 - Marie Curie (1911) – for her discovery of radium and polonium.
 - Linus Pauling (1954) – for his research into the nature of the chemical bond and its application to the elucidation of the structure of complex substances.

- **Medicine:**

- Albert Calmette (1919) – for the development of the BCG vaccine for tuberculosis.
- Charles Darwin – Although he did not receive a Nobel Prize, his evolutionary theory has shaped much of modern medicine.

- **Economics:**

- Amartya Sen (1998) – for his contributions to welfare economics.
- Esther Duflo (2019) – for her experimental approach to poverty alleviation.

Nobel Prize 2024 winners:

Field	Nobel Prize Winners	Awarded For
Physiology/Medicine	- Victor Ambros (USA) - Gary Ruvkun (USA)	Discovery of microRNAs
Physics	- John J. Hopfield (USA) - Geoffrey E. Hinton (British-Canadian)	Use of statistical physics concepts in the development of artificial neural networks
Chemistry	- David Baker (USA) - Demis Hassabis (British) - John M. Jumper (USA)	- To David Baker 'for computational protein design.' - Demis Hassabis and John M. Jumper 'for protein structure prediction.'
Literature	Han Kang (South Korean writer)	For her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life
Peace	Nihon Hidankyo (Japanese organization)	For its efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons and for demonstrating

		through witness testimony that nuclear weapons must never be used again
Economics	- Daron Acemoglu (USA) - Simon Johnson (USA) - James A. Robinson (USA)	For studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity

Booker Prize

- The Booker Prize, originally known as the Man Booker Prize, is one of the most prestigious literary awards in the English-speaking world.
- It is awarded annually to the best original novel written in English, regardless of the author's nationality.
- The prize was established in 1969 by the Booker McConnell company (later known as Booker Group) and has evolved over the years.
- In 2002, the prize was officially renamed the "Man Booker Prize" after the Man Group became its sponsor.



- In 2019, the prize dropped the "Man" sponsorship and became simply the "Booker Prize."

- The book must be written in English and published in the UK or Ireland. Authors from any country are eligible, which has helped to elevate global voices in literature.
- Each year, the prize has a longlist of around 12 to 13 books, which is narrowed down to a shortlist of six books. The final winner is selected by a panel of judges.

Notable Winners:

- **Arundhati Roy (1997) – *The God of Small Things***

Roy became the first Indian author to win the Booker Prize for her debut novel, which explored themes of caste, politics, and forbidden love in India.

- **Hilary Mantel (2009, 2012) – *Wolf Hall***

Mantel won the Booker twice for her historical fiction about Thomas Cromwell and the English monarchy.

- **Salman Rushdie (1981) – *Midnight's Children***

This novel, which blends history and magic, won the Booker Prize and went on to be awarded the Booker of Bookers in 2008.

Booker Prize Winners 2023 and 2024:

Year	Category	Winners	Title	Publisher	Judges
2023	Winner	Paul Lynch	<i>Prophet Song</i>	Oneworld Publications	- Esi Edugyan (chair) - Adjoa Andoh - Mary Jean Chan - James S. Shapiro - Robert Webb
	Shortlist	Sarah Bernstein	<i>Study for Obedience</i>	Granta	
		Jonathan Escoffery	<i>If I Survive You</i>	4th Estate	

		Paul Harding	<i>This Other Eden</i>	Hutchinson Heinemann	
		Paul Murray	<i>The Bee Sting</i>	Hamish Hamilton	
		Chetna Maroo	<i>Western Lane</i>	Picador	
2024	Winner	Samantha Harvey	<i>Orbital</i>	Jonathan Cape	- Edmund de Waal (chair) - Sara Collins - Justine Jordan - Yiyun Li - Nitin Sawhney
	Shortlist	Percival Everett	<i>James</i>	Mantle	
		Rachel Kushner	<i>Creation Lake</i>	Jonathan Cape	
		Anne Michaels	<i>Held</i>	Bloomsbury	
		Yael van der Wouden	<i>The Safekeep</i>	Viking	
		Charlotte Wood	<i>Stone Yard Devotional</i>	Sceptre	

Academy Awards (Oscars)

- The Academy Awards, also known as the Oscars, are annual awards presented by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (AMPAS) to recognise excellence in cinematic achievements.

- The Oscars are one of the most prestigious and well-known awards in the film industry
- The first Academy Awards ceremony was held on May 16, 1929. It was initially a private dinner, but over time, it has become a grand public event.
- The ceremony is typically held in Los Angeles, with the Dolby Theatre being the main venue since 2002. The event is broadcast live across the world and includes red-carpet arrivals, performances, and speeches.

Notable Winners:

- Best Director:
 - *Steven Spielberg (1993) – for Schindler’s List*
Spielberg won for his powerful portrayal of the Holocaust.
- Best Actor:
 - *Daniel Day-Lewis (2013) – for Lincoln*
Day-Lewis won his third Best Actor Oscar for his portrayal of Abraham Lincoln, making him the first actor to win three Best Actor Oscars.
- Best Picture:
 - *Titanic (1998)*
Directed by James Cameron, *Titanic* swept the 1998 Oscars, winning 11 awards, including Best Picture.

2023 and 2024 winners:

Year	Category	Winner(s)	Movie/Contribution
2023	Best Actor	Brendan Fraser	<i>The Whale</i>
	Best Actress	Michelle Yeoh	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>
	Best Supporting Actor	Ke Huy Quan	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>
	Best Supporting Actress	Jamie Lee Curtis	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>

	Best Director	Daniel Kwan and Daniel Scheinert	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>
	Best Original Screenplay	Daniel Kwan and Daniel Scheinert	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>
	Best Movie	<i>Everything Everywhere All at Once</i>	-
2024	Best Actor	Cillian Murphy	<i>Oppenheimer</i>
	Best Actress	Emma Stone	<i>Poor Things</i>
	Best Supporting Actor	Robert Downey Jr.	<i>Oppenheimer</i>
	Best Supporting Actress	Da'Vine Joy Randolph	<i>The Holdovers</i>
	Best Director	Christopher Nolan	<i>Oppenheimer</i>
	Best Original Screenplay	Justine Triet and Arthur Harari	<i>Anatomy of a Fall</i>
	Best Movie	<i>Oppenheimer</i>	-

Laureus World Sports Awards

- The Laureus World Sports Awards are prestigious international honours presented annually to recognise outstanding achievements in the world of sports.
- They were established in 1999 by the Laureus Sport for Good Foundation.

Notable winners

- Usain Bolt (2009, 2010, 2017) – won Athlete of the Year multiple times for his dominance in sprinting, particularly in the 100m and 200m events.
- Serena Williams (2003, 2016) – awarded Female Athlete of the Year, recognizing her achievements in tennis.

- FC Barcelona (2011) – won Team of the Year for their unparalleled success in football, including winning the 2010-11 UEFA Champions League.

Laureus World Sports Awards winners from 2023 and 2024:

Year	Category	Winner(s)	Sport
2024	World Sportsman of the Year	Novak Djokovic	Tennis
	World Sportswoman of the Year	Aitana Bonmatí	Football
	World Team of the Year	Spain Women's Football Team	Football
	World Breakthrough of the Year	Jude Bellingham	Football
	World Comeback of the Year	Simone Biles	Gymnastics
	World Action Sportsperson of the Year	Arisa Trew	Skateboarding
	World Sportsperson of the Year with a Disability	Diede de Groot	Wheelchair Tennis
	Sport for Good Award	Fundación Rafa Nadal	-
2023	World Sportsman of the Year	Lionel Messi	Football
	World Sportswoman of the Year	Shelly-Ann Fraser-Pryce	Athletics
	World Team of the Year	Argentina Men's Football Team	Football
	World Breakthrough of the Year	Carlos Alcaraz	Tennis
	World Comeback of the Year	Christian Eriksen	Football

	World Action Sports person of the Year	Eileen Gu	Freestyle Skiing
	World Sports person of the Year with a Disability	Catherine Debrunner	Wheelchair Racing
	Sport for Good Award	TeamUp	-

Gandhi Peace Prize

- The Gandhi Peace Prize is a prestigious international award presented by the Government of India in recognition of individuals or organizations who have made significant contributions toward promoting peace, non-violence, and social justice.
- It was instituted in 1995 by the Indian government in honour of Mahatma Gandhi, marking the 125th anniversary of his birth.
- The prize aims to honour individuals and institutions that have made outstanding contributions to the promotion of peace, social development, and non-violence, following the principles of Mahatma Gandhi
- It is awarded to those who have promoted non-violence, social equality, and peace. The recipients may come from diverse fields, including politics, social work, literature, or activism.
- The recipient of the Gandhi Peace Prize receives a monetary award and a citation. The monetary value has varied over the years but is generally around ₹1 crore (approximately \$135,000).
- The prize is awarded annually on the occasion of Mahatma Gandhi's birth anniversary, October 2.

Notable Winners:

- **Nelson Mandela (1995)** – awarded for his role in leading South Africa out of apartheid through peaceful negotiation.
- **Dr. A. P. J. Abdul Kalam (2007)** – for his contributions to peace and the development of India, especially in science and technology.
- **Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. (2001, posthumously)**
- **Aung San Suu Kyi (2012)**

- Ellen Johnson Sirleaf, Leymah Gbowee, and Tawakkol Karman (2018, jointly)
- Sheikh Mujibur Rahman (2020): Awarded posthumously for his exceptional contributions to social, economic, and political transformation.
- **Gita Press, Gorakhpur (2021):** Honored for its significant role in promoting peace and social harmony.

